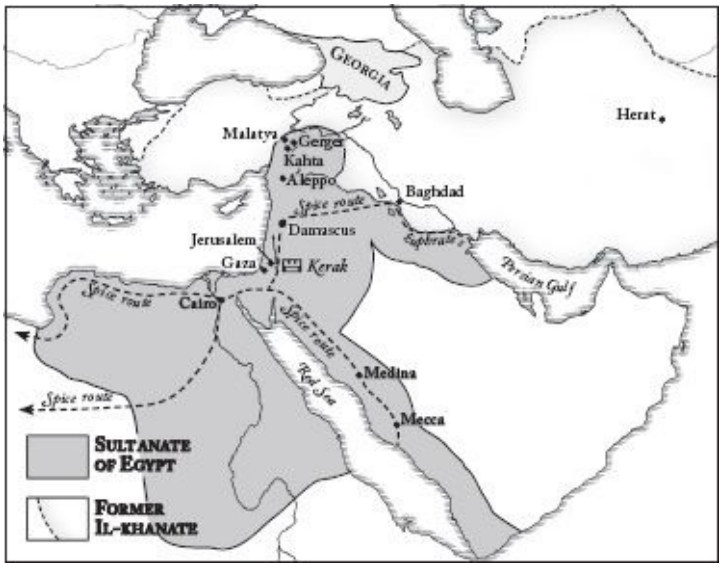
offend Abu Sa'id; he put the boy in jail and then executed him the following year. Abu Sa'id then forced the beautiful Khatun to divorce her husband, and married her himself. At twenty, he was now in full control of the Il-khanate.

Unlike al-Nasir in Egypt, he did not blossom into an efficient ruler. To replace Chupan, he appointed one of his favorites, the minister Ghiyath al-Din: a good man, of "angelic temperament," a contemporary account says, but incompetent. "Instead of punishing those who had wrought . . . ill deeds," the chronicler says, "he drew the pen of forgiveness through the record of their crimes, recompensed their evil actions with good, and . . . entrust[ed] to them the most important functions." The Il-khanate was in a downward spiral, and Abu Sa'id did not live long enough to mature into its savior. Ibn Battuta, repeating court gossip, says that around 1335 Abu Sa'id developed a "violent passion" for a new wife, and neglected Chupan's daughter Khatun: "She became jealous in consequence, and administered poison to him. . . . So he died, and his line became extinct."[12]

The Christian kingdom of Georgia at once declared its independence under George V. And Muslim dynasties, ruling over mini-kingdoms, sprang up all over the old Il-khanate lands: "When the King died and left no issue," Ibn Battuta writes, "each of the governors assumed the government of the district over which he had been placed." Almost overnight, the entire Il-khanate vanished.[13]



64.1 The Collapse of the Il-khanate